MCP

Title:
Assignment: Apple

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ASSIGNMENT: APPLE

By Mike Noland

Scene
INT: Alex's bedroom

This scene takes place in a bedroom. Any bedroom will do. The characters can be male, female or non-binary because…they are just people. Well, not people exactly but high school students. It's the bedroom of a high school student and their friend arrives to come up with ideas for an assignment they have in their English class. From here, I think you can figure it out. Good luck, oh… and have fun!

Alex

(Alex is looking at his/her notebook in the bedroom.)
What kind of assignment is this anyway? An apple, really. We have to do something, anything creative with an apple? (Phone goes off, looks to see who it is, then answers.) Where are you? We are supposed to be working on this stupid project together. At the Police station? What did you do?

Taylor

(Taylor walks into the room on the phone.)
(Still on the phone at first) I was picking out flower arrangements. (Puts down phone and laughs) You really thought I was at the police station? (Laughs some more.)

Alex

Well with you, you never know. Plus I'm really stressed about this stupid assignment. I just don't understand what he's wanting. (Reading from the notebook again. Uses a fake teacher voice.)" You may do anything creative to describe an apple. Write a poem, a short story, a haiku, whatever creative outlet you want to use. The key is to describe the apple in a way that is not ordinary." It's an APPLE!

Taylor

Relax, you are letting this get to you. This is a chance to do something fun and exciting.

Alex

Yeah, like getting a D or an F.

Taylor

(Laughing) You are looking at this all wrong. We can do whatever we want. Don't you get it? As long as we try and at least describe an apple in a different way, we are golden, Golden Delicious. Get it…golden delicious is a type of apple. The sky's the limit here. He has just given us a license to ill.

Alex

What? License to ill?

Taylor

I just mean, there are no limits. We have total freedom. I find that exhilarating.

Alex

I find that nauseating. I like guidelines that I can see. Guidelines that I can follow, that make sense. Not this weird, free-association, nonsense. I need structure. Not this loosey-goosey, livin-in-a-commune-with-old hippies stuff. We'll just write a poem!

Taylor

NO. That's what half the class will end up doing. (Looks around the room for a second. Finds a pencil and walks over to Alex.) Here just take this pencil and stab me in the eye with it because I would rather you do that then write a poem.

Alex

Fine, what's your idea?

Taylor

Here me out. I've been thinking about this all day. Let's make a film.

Alex

A film? You mean like a movie?

Taylor

You say movie, I say film but it's the same thing. Just think about it. Everyone else in class is gonna write some crappy poem or ridiculous short story. Then they will have to get up and read it to the class. We will all have to sit and listen to this dribble till our ears are bleeding. But if we make a film…

Alex

Movie…

Taylor

Whatever, the class will go nuts. We will be like a pizza to a starving man.

Alex

Why pizza?

Taylor

Cause it's more fun and that's what we will be…FUN.

Alex

Alright, suppose I agree to this. What sort of movie…

Taylor

Film..

Alex

…are we talking about? We can't just say "Here's an apple. It comes in many colors and flavors."

Taylor

No, we can make it like a spy story or an adventure film and the fruit can talk. Whatever we want. And as the story goes on, we find unique ways to describe the apple. It doesn't have to be long, just interesting. I'll bet he has never had any students do anything like this before. He'll love it.

Alex

But what if he doesn't?

Taylor

Even if he doesn't he will still give us credit for trying as long as we describe the apple, that's the key. Why not have some fun with this?

Alex

(Thinking before speaking.) Hmmm. I have a few questions.

Taylor

Shoot.

Alex

Have you ever written a script before?

Taylor

Nope, next question.

Alex

Have you ever shot a movie before?

Taylor

Film and no. Next.

Alex

What makes you think we can do this?

Taylor

I don't know. We may go down in flames. This may be the single biggest mistake of our young lives. But why not give it a try. How hard can it be? I've seen some really terrible movies and somebody got paid to write those…so?

Alex

That's true. But how are we gonna shoot this?

Taylor

Are you kidding? (Holds up the phone.) We have all we need right here. We can shoot it, edit it, add music and even special effects if we want. Everything we need is right here.

Alex

Except one thing.

Taylor

The script. So the first thing we need to do is decide what the story will be about. But is there something that has to come first?

Alex

Like what?

Taylor

Well I don't know about you, but I'm starving. I haven't eaten since breakfast.

Alex

You didn't eat lunch.

Taylor

Well, typically, in most cultures, lunch follows breakfast. And if you had breakfast and you have not eaten since that time. Most would assume, and correctly I might add, that you skipped lunch. So no, I did not eat lunch.

Alex

Wow, that was a long walk off a short pier. You didn't have to be quite so snarly.

Taylor

Perhaps I have the hangries. You know angry cause I'm hungry

Alex

I know what the hangries are. I may have a granola bar in my backpack.

Taylor

Great or I could just chew on a belt. It would have about as much flavor.

Alex

For someone that's starving you are certainly picky.

Taylor

Maybe I'll just go into your kitchen and see what's in the fridge or the pantry.
(Starts to walk out.)

Alex

No, if you go to the kitchen, we won't get started for like an hour.

Taylor

What?!! Your kitchen is across the hall, not the country.

Alex

But I know you. You will start out for the kitchen and then you'll see my mom and start talking to her. Then you guys will start laughing and it won't stop.

Taylor

I love your Mom. She's the best and so funny.

Alex

I know, I agree but right now we need to work.

Taylor

Okay, I promise I won't talk to your Mom. I will run into the kitchen and grab the first thing I see and run back. It will take me 10 seconds. You can time me.

Alex

I don't want to time you. This is not an olympic event.

Taylor

Oh, but that would be a cool one if they had it. (Taylor closes his/her eyes and starts pantomiming, opening things and grabbing things.)

Alex

What are you doing?

Taylor

I'm practicing. That way when I'm there I won't waste time. (Pantomiming with eyes open this time.) There's the fridge and I'm opening the door. Give it a quick glance. How old is that spaghetti?

Alex

There's no spaghetti in there.

Taylor

Well, there could have been. I was kind of hoping there was. It sounded good. (Pantomimes again.) Checking in the pantry. (Looks up and down.) Are those Oreos still good?

Alex

How did you know there were Oreos in there?

Taylor

Everyone has Oreos. But that's not what I'm hungry for. Maybe just some chips. You got any Hawaiian Punch?

Alex

Always. Will you just hurry up, we gotta get started.

Taylor

Are you gonna time me?

Alex

Really?

Taylor

Yes and say the numbers out loud. That will motivate me. Are you ready?

Alex

Yes…

(Taylor can run to the side of the stage and pantomime all the action or run up stage with back to the audience and stand still. These are just suggestions, they're good but you can do whatever you want. After all, you're the ones performing.)

1…2…3…4…5…6…7…8…9

(Taylor runs back in.)

Taylor

(Pantomimes carrying chips and a juicebox.You'll see why in a minute.)
Made it with a second to spare. Whew, I'm good. I even waved at your Mom.

Alex

(Sarcastically)
Oh, that's nice.

Taylor

Is she doing something different with her hair? It looks nice.

Alex

I don't know and I don't care.

Taylor

Well that's not a very nice attitude for the woman that raised you. Not to mention the nine months she lugged you around in her belly. That couldn't have been much of a picnic.

Alex

Would it be possible to start working soon? Believe it or not, this isn't the only homework I have to do, ya know.

Taylor

Sounds like someone else might have the hangries. Want some chips?

Alex

Is that a juicebox?

Taylor

Uh huh! (Take a sip.) And it's good too.

Alex

Was that the last one?

Taylor

Uhhh… maybe?

Alex

And it's a fruit punch, isn't it?

Taylor

Yes and it's deee-licious.

Alex

That's just great! Can we get started now??

Taylor

I'm ready to go, let's do this.

Alex

So, what's your idea for the screenplay?

Taylor

Let's see…(thinks) yep, I got nothing.

Alex

Nothing, what do you mean nothing? This was your idea.

Taylor

My idea was to write a screenplay and make a film. I don't have a clue what it will be about.

Alex

Maybe the first thing we could do is get the names of different types of apples.

Taylor

For someone who hasn't written a screenplay before, you are quite good at this.

Alex

Thanks, let's start naming different types of apples. There's Honeycrisp, Gala, Granny Smith..

Taylor

Oh, I bet we could do some funny stuff with a Granny Smith. Maybe she's the crotchety old lady that lives next door. She's always yelling at the little kid apples. "Stop playing in the street. You wanna car to hit you and turn you into apple sauce? Then we would see your pale yellow insides splattered all over the road."

Alex

I see where you are going with this but it might be a little graphic, don't ya think?

Taylor

Trust me, the guys will love it and it gets a little of the description of the inside of the apple. Which unless I'm mistaken, is part of the assignment.

Alex

Well, that's true. We'll just put a pin in the idea for a minute. Let's keep coming up with some more names.

Taylor

There's McIntosh, Red Delicious and Fuji, which is one of my favs.

Alex

And Ambrosia, Evercrisp and Pink Lady.

Taylor

Pink Lady! Hey that's it. We could do, like a whole musical thing using songs from Grease. You know cause the Pink Lady's are the cool chicks in Grease.

Alex

Musical, are you crazy? Listen, we are stretching it to write a screenplay. I'm not gonna try and add music too.

Taylor

We don't have to write the music. That's already been done. All we have to do is rewrite the lyrics to the songs that they already have.

Alex

Well, I'm not singing, are you singing?

Taylor

Actually, I'm more of a writer-director. Ok, so maybe not a musical but what about if we got a whole bunch of fruit and made it look like a party. All the fruit are hanging out and talking like you do at a party. Then a banana comes up to an apple and says, "Hey Red, you sure look sweet. A bunch of us over there were wondering how you keep yourself so shiny." Get it? Bunch…bananas? We could do fruit puns and jokes.

Alex

Well…I don't hate it but I don't think we have any fruit. So you know what that means, right?

(They both look at each other and smile and then answer at the same time.)

Alex	Taylor
Grocery store run	Road trip

Alex

Wait, What did you say?

Taylor

I thought you were gonna say, a road trip. Just cause, ya know, that would be fun.

Alex

Well, I guess we could take a road trip to the grocery store. We're gonna need a lot of fruit.

Taylor

Hahaha yeah!!

Alex

Let's get going, we gotta get this done. You got any money?

Taylor

Uh, no. You?

Alex

No…(thinking.) But I know where to get some. Come on and follow my lead.
(Starting to leave the room)
Mom, we gotta run to the store. (As they exit. This could be done to the side or upstage with backs to the audience.) Hey, what did you do to your hair, it looks amazing!!

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